MIL-E-44200
AMENDMENT-2
1 December 1987
SUPERSEDING
AMENDMENT-1
5 February 1987

MILITARY SPECIFICATION

ESCALLOPED POTATOES WITH HAM, THERMOSTABILIZED, FOR MEAL, READY-TO-EAT

This amendment forms a part of Military Specification MIL-E-44200, dated 15 January 1986, and is approved for use by all Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense.

PAGE 2

2.1, under U.S. DEPARTMENT OF AGRICULTURE (USDA): Add:

"Meat and Poultry Inspection Regulations

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402.)"

PAGE 3

2.2: Add the following:

"AMERICAN ASSOCIATION OF CEREAL CHEMISTS (AACC)

Approved Methods of the American Association of Cereal Chemists

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Association of Cereal Chemists, 3340 Pilot Knob Road, St. Paul, MN 55121.)"

3.2.2, line 1: Delete "grade" and substitute "style".

PAGE 4

* 3.2.4, line 6: Delete "approximately 3/8 by 3/8 by 1/2 inch dimensions" and substitute "3/8 inch cubes".

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* 3.3.1 Delete and substitute:

"3.3.1 Preparation of ham. The ham shall be diced into 3/8 by 3/8 by 1/2 to 3/4 inch dices. The ham dices shall be maintained in the temperature range of 28° to 40°F for not more than 48 hours from the time of dicing to product preparation."

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* 3.3.2.1: Delete and substitute:

"3.3.2.1 Preparation of fresh potatoes. The fresh potatoes shall be thoroughly cleaned to remove dark and extraneous material, peeled, trimmed, and thoroughly washed. The washed potatoes shall be mechanically diced into 3/8 inch cubes. The potato dice shall be blanched sufficiently to prevent discoloration and to remove excess air. The blanched potatoes shall be immediately cooled with cooling water to the initial temperature of the cooling water and thoroughly drained. The cooled drained potato dice shall be handled in a manner to prevent discoloration, and filled into the pouches within 4 hours after blanching."

PAGE 6

* 3.3.3, line 2: Delete "cold water" and substitute "part of the sauce formulation water".

* 3.3.4, line 4: Delete "and ham broth".

PAGE 7

* 3.3.5: Delete in entirety and substitute:

"3.3.5 Product preparation. The product shall be formulated and prepared such as to comply with the finished product requirement (see 3.6 and 6.4)."

* 3.4 e: Delete "1 hour" and substitute "2 hours".

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* 3.6 d: Delete and substitute:

"d. No individual pouch shall contain a bone piece measuring 0.3 inch or more in any dimension."

* 3.6 m, after "dices": Delete remainder of sentence.

3.6 q: Delete "8.0 and substitute "6.0".

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4.5.1.1: Delete and substitute:

"4.5.1.1 Ingredient and component examination. Conformance of ingredients and components to identity, condition, and other requirements specified in 3.2 shall be certified by the ingredient supplier or ingredient manufacturer, or compliance be verified by examination of pertinent labels, markings, US Grade Certificates, certificates of analyses, or other such valid documents acceptable to the inspection agency. If necessary, each ingredient shall be examined organoleptically or inspected according to generally recognized test methods, such as the standard methods described in the Official Methods of Analysis of the Association of Official Analytical Chemists and in the Approved Methods of the American Association of Cereal Chemists, to determine conformance to the requirements. Any nonconformance to an identity, condition, or other requirement shall be cause for rejection of the ingredient or component lot or of any involved product."

PAGES 10, 11, 12

* 4.5.5: Delete in entirety and substitute the following new paragraphs and tables:

"4.5.5 Product and drained weight inspection.

4.5.5.1 Product inspection. The filled and sealed sample pouches shall be held for a minimum of 72 hours at room temperature (65° to 75°F) after completion of the thermoprocessing operation. The pouches shall be heated in 180° to 190°F water for 10 minutes, opened, and inspected. The lot size shall be expressed in pouches. The sample unit shall be the contents of one pouch. The sample size shall be as indicated by the sampling plan specified in table I. The contents shall be inspected for the defects indicated in table II.

TABLE I. Double sampling plan for product inspection 1/

Lot size (pouches)	Sample size (pouches)	Cumulative sample	Acceptance number	Rejection number
0 to 500,000	20	--	0	2
	20	40	1	2

1/ a. If no defects are found in the first sample, the lot shall be accepted.

b. If the number of defects found in the first sample equals or exceeds the rejection number, the lot shall be rejected.

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PAGES 10, 11, 14 (cont'd)

c. If the number of defects found in the first sample exceeds the acceptance number but is less than the rejection number, the second sample shall be inspected. Defects found in the first and second sample shall be combined and if the number of defects in the cumulative sample equals or exceeds the rejection number, the lot shall be rejected.

TABLE II. Product defects 1/ 2/

Category	Defect
Major	
101	Presence of a bone piece measuring 0.3 inch or more in any dimension.
102	Presence of cartilage, coarse connective tissue, or section of tendons or ligaments measuring more than 0.3 inch in any dimension.
103	Presence of skin, blood clot, bruise, or discolored meat measuring more than 0.3 inch in any dimension.
104	Less than 75 percent of the ham consists of dicernible dices.
105	Texture of ham dices is dry, rubbery or mushy.
106	Texture of potatoes is hard, rubbery, fibrous or mushy.
107	Sauce consistence is lumpy or is excessively thick or thin.
108	Product shows evidence or excess heating (materially darkened or scorched).

1/ The presence of foreign material (e.g., glass, dirt, insect parts, hair, wood, metal), foreign odor or flavor (e.g., burnt, scorched, moldy, rancid, sour, stale), or foreign color shall be cause for rejection of the lot.

2/ Product not equal to or better than the approved preproduction sample (see 6.1) in palatability or overall appearance shall be cause for rejection of the lot. (This comparison shall be performed only when deemed necessary by an AMS agent.)

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PAGES 10, 11, 12 (cont'd)

4.5.5.2 Drained weight inspection. The filled and sealed sample pouches shall be held for a minimum of 72 hours at room temperature (65° to 75°F) after completion of the thermoprocessing operation. The lot size shall be expressed in pouches. The sample unit shall be the contents of one pouch. The sample size shall be as indicated by the double sampling plan specified in table III. The drained weights shall be determined and inspected for the defects listed in table IV.

TABLE III. Double sampling plan for drained weight inspection 1/ 2/

Lot size (pouches)	Sample size (pouches)	Cumulative sample	Acceptance number	Rejection number
0 to 500,000	20	--	0	2
	20	40	1	2

1/ a. If no defects are found in the first sample, the lot shall be accepted.

b. If the number of defects found in the first sample equals or exceeds the rejection number, the lot shall be rejected.

c. If the number of defects found in the first sample exceeds the acceptance number but is less than the rejection number, the second sample shall be inspected. Defects found in the first and second samples shall be combined and if the number of defects in the cumulative sample equals or exceeds the rejection number, the lot shall be rejected.

2/ To determine drained weight, the pouch contents shall be poured into a flat-bottom container. A minimum of three times the pouch's volume of 180° to 190°F water shall be added to the container so as to cover the contents. The contents and water shall be gently agitated such as to liquify rendered fat and to remove the sauce without breaking the ham dices or potatoes. The contents shall then be poured into a U.S. Standard 1/4 inch sieve in a manner that will distribute the product over the sieve without breaking the ham dices or potatoes. Sieve area shall be such that the distributed product does not completely cover all the openings of the sieve. The sieve shall be tilted at an approximate 45 degree angle and allowed to drain for 2 minutes. The drained weight of the ham dices and potatoes shall be determined individually and shall be reported to the nearest 0.1 ounce.

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PAGES 10, 11, 12 (cont'd)

TABLE IV. Drained weight defects

Category	Defect
Major	
101	Drained weight of ham dices in a pouch is less than 2.5 ounces. 1/
102	Drained weight of potatoes in a pouch is less than 1.5 ounces. 2/

1/ If the sample average drained weight of the ham is less than 3.0 ounces, the lot shall be rejected.

2/ If the sample average drained weight of the potatoes is less than 2.0 ounces, the lot shall be rejected."

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* Add the following new paragraph:

"6.4 Product preparation. Production tests have indicated that the following proportion of ingredients should produce a product which complies with the finished product requirements. Minor adjustments of the ingredient percentages by weight may be necessary in order to satisfy the different production systems.

a. When using fresh potatoes:

Ingredient	Percent by weight
Ham, diced	47.8
Potatoes, diced, fresh	25.0
Sauce	27.2

b. When using dehydrofrozen potatoes:

Ingredient	Percent by weight
Ham, diced	47.8
Potatoes, diced, dehydrofrozen	12.5
Sauce	27.2
Water	12.5 "

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Army - GL

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